

VPN and Remote Access Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy governs the use of Virtual Private Network (VPN) and other remote access mechanisms used by TCS employees to connect to internal systems from outside the office network.

2. Scope

Applies to all employees, interns, and contractors who access TCS internal systems remotely, including from home, client sites, or while traveling.

3. Definitions

VPN	Virtual Private Network — an encrypted tunnel connecting a remote device securely to the company network.
Split Tunneling	A VPN configuration where only company traffic is routed through the VPN, and other internet traffic uses the local connection.

4. VPN Purpose

The TCS VPN (GlobalProtect) creates a secure, encrypted connection between an employee's device and internal company systems, protecting data in transit and enabling access to resources such as internal wikis, code repositories, and client environments that are not exposed to the public internet. VPN use is essential whenever an employee is not connected to the trusted office network.

5. Who Can Use VPN

All confirmed and probationary employees are issued VPN access as part of their IT account provisioning during onboarding (see Onboarding Policy, TCS-HR-006). Contractors and interns receive VPN access only where their role requires remote access to internal systems, subject to manager and IT Security approval.

6. VPN Login Process

To connect to the VPN:

- 1 Open the GlobalProtect client on the company laptop.
- 2 Enter your company email ID and password.
- 3 Approve the Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) prompt on your registered authenticator app.
- 4 Once connected, the VPN status icon turns green in the system tray.

VPN sessions automatically time out after 10 hours of inactivity and must be re-established.

7. MFA Requirements

MFA is mandatory for every VPN login, with no exceptions, consistent with the Cyber Security Policy (TCS-IT-002). Employees must not approve an MFA prompt they did not personally initiate; doing so may grant an attacker access to company systems and must be reported to the Security Operations Center immediately.

8. Remote Access Rules

Company systems, including email, internal applications, and client environments, must only be accessed via the VPN when working outside the office network, including while on an approved Work From Home day (see Work From Home Policy, TCS-HR-004). Split tunneling is disabled by default for all employees; all traffic from the company laptop routes through the VPN while connected, in line with data protection requirements.

9. Approved Devices

Only company-issued laptops with the GlobalProtect client and endpoint protection pre-installed are approved for VPN access. Personal devices (personal laptops, tablets, or phones) are not permitted to connect to the company VPN or access internal systems, except for company email and calendar via the approved mobile app with device management enrolled.

10. Public Network Restrictions

As detailed in the Cyber Security Policy (TCS-IT-002), employees should avoid public Wi-Fi where possible. **Yes, you can access company systems from public Wi-Fi, but only if connected via the VPN at all times** — direct access to company email, applications, or data over public Wi-Fi without an active VPN connection is strictly prohibited.

11. VPN Security

The VPN client automatically enforces device compliance checks (up-to-date antivirus definitions, disk encryption enabled, OS patches current) before allowing a connection. Devices that fail compliance checks are granted only limited network access until remediated by IT.

12. Troubleshooting

Common VPN issues and first-line fixes:

- **Cannot connect:** Confirm internet connectivity, restart the GlobalProtect client, and verify the MFA app is not expired.
- **Slow connection:** Restart the VPN session; if persistent, run the network diagnostic tool available in the GlobalProtect client.
- **MFA not received:** Check phone connectivity and ensure the authenticator app time is synced; use backup codes if configured.

If these steps do not resolve the issue, raise a ticket with the IT Helpdesk.

13. Reporting Access Problems

Persistent VPN or remote access issues, or any suspected unauthorized access attempt, should be reported to the IT Helpdesk (for technical issues) or the Security Operations Center (for suspected security incidents) without delay.

14. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Why do I need VPN?

A: The VPN encrypts your connection to company systems, protecting sensitive data in transit and giving you access to internal resources that aren't available on the public internet.

Q: Can I access company systems from public Wi-Fi?

A: Only if you connect via the company VPN first. Direct access to company systems over public Wi-Fi without VPN is prohibited under the Cyber Security Policy (TCS-IT-002).

Q: Can I use my personal laptop to connect to the VPN?

A: No. Only company-issued laptops with GlobalProtect and endpoint protection installed are approved for VPN access.

Q: What do I do if VPN keeps disconnecting?

A: Restart the GlobalProtect client and check your internet connection; if the issue persists, raise a ticket with the IT Helpdesk.

15. Contact Information

IT Helpdesk	it.support@tcs-internal.com Ext. 1200
Security Operations Center	security.soc@tcs-internal.com 24x7 Hotline: 1800-XXX-SOC1